

AI-DLC

AI-Driven Development Lifecycle

The methodology that accelerates 100% of software development — not just coding.

5–10×

Productivity Gain

100%

SDLC Coverage

2 Days

Weeks → Days

What is AI-DLC?

AI-Driven Development Life Cycle (AI-DLC) is an AI-native development methodology specifically designed to integrate tools, roles, and processes for building complex systems at scale — redesigned from scratch for how to work with AI.



AI-Human Collaboration

AI drives the process, humans make strategic decisions. Neither alone — together, optimally.



Systematic Verification

Production quality is ensured through review & verification at each stage of the lifecycle.



Structured Deliverables

Code, tests, and infrastructure generated alongside 12+ structured design documents.

The AI Productivity Paradox

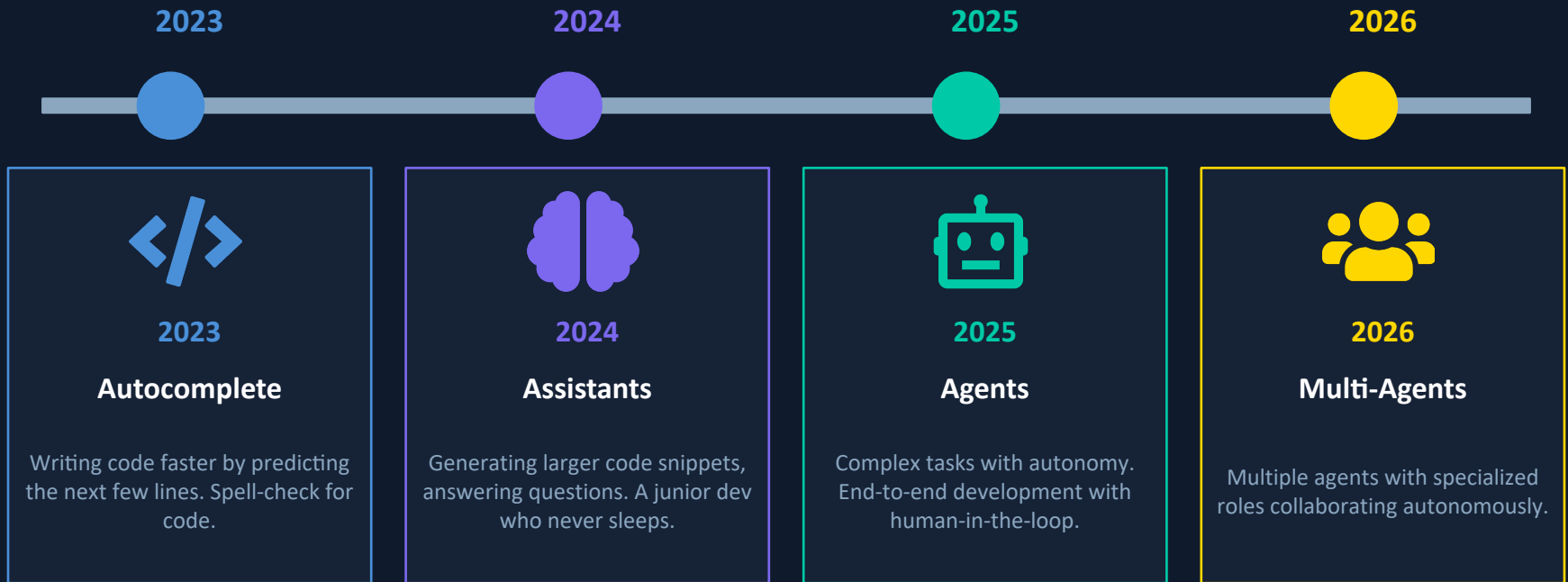
The Problem

- ✗ AI coding tools only accelerate coding — just 20% of total development work
- ✗ Result: only 10–15% overall productivity improvement
- ✗ Some studies show AI tools making developers 19% SLOWER (METR.org, 2025)
- ✗ Reason: prompting overhead + context switching + overconfidence bias

AI-DLC Solution

- ✓ Accelerates 100% of the development process — design, analysis, comm, testing, code
- ✓ Achieves 5–10× productivity improvement with enterprise production quality
- ✓ AI plans and executes; humans focus on verification and strategic decisions
- ✓ Structured methodology makes AI tools actually work — not just noise

Evolution of AI Development Tools



Stages of AI Coding — And Why They Fall Short

Stage 1

Vibe Coding

How: "Build me a login feature" → AI returns code directly

Problem: Trapped in endless modification loops. You fix everything yourself.

Stage 2

Spec-Based

How: Write a spec → AI develops from it

Problem: AI guesses missing details. Non-functional requirements absent. MVP-quality only.

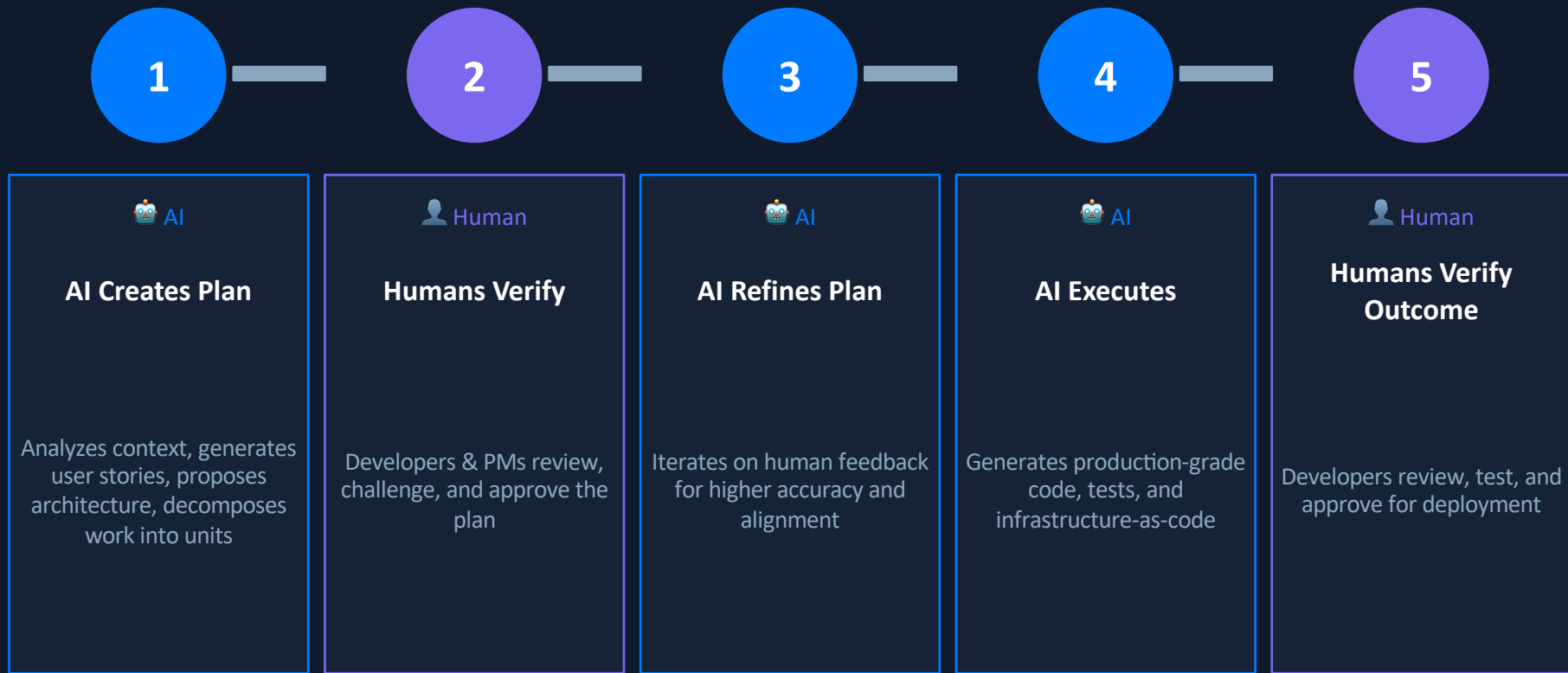
Stage 3

AI-DLC ✓

How: Requirements → Structured context docs → Production-quality code

Result: Systematic prompt chain with verification at every step. 5–10× productivity.

How AI-DLC Works — The Operating Model



Key Principle: Humans are ALWAYS in the verification seat — developers become Technical Directors, not typists.

The 3-Phase AI-DLC Process

Phase 1: Inception

Deciding What to Build

1. Build context on existing code
2. Elaborate intent with user stories
3. Plan with units of work (Bolts)

Mob Elaboration



Phase 2: Construction

Actually Building It

1. Domain model & architecture
2. Generate code + tests simultaneously
3. Add security, observability, resilience
4. Deploy with IaC & tests

Mob Construction



Phase 3: Operations

Deploying & Running It

1. Deploy to production with IaC
2. AI-first incident detection & resolution

Self-healing Systems

Where Time Actually Goes in SDLC

20%

Actual coding time in a typical sprint

80%

Waiting, meetings, handoffs, reviews, approvals

The Real Bottleneck — Wait States:



Waiting for environment setup



Context switching between tasks



Waiting for security approvals



Meeting overhead & re-alignment



Waiting for code reviews

AI-DLC collapses wait states with parallel work, automated approvals & AI-first incident resolution — that's where 3–5× gains come from.

Three Approaches — Only One Works

AI-Managed

Give AI full autonomy. No human oversight.

- ✗ Fails for complex systems
- ✗ Unreliable & unexplainable
- ✗ No developer connection to code
- ✗ Technical debt accumulates fast
- ✗ Debug nightmare at 2 AM

AI-Assisted

Developers do everything, AI helps narrow tasks.

- ⚠ Only optimizes 20% of work
- ⚠ Manual inefficiencies persist
- ⚠ Handoff tax remains
- ⚠ Tech debt from Frankenstein code
- ⚠ 10–15% gain at best

AI-DLC ★

AI orchestrates, humans verify & decide.

- ✓ 5–10× productivity gain
- ✓ Production-grade quality
- ✓ Humans always in control
- ✓ Context flows through all phases
- ✓ Predictable, scalable delivery

The Goldilocks Zone

Role Transformation — Everyone Levels Up

Developer	Before: Writes code from scratch, interprets requirements, manages boilerplate	→	After: Technical Director: validates AI-generated architecture, orchestrates codebase vision
Product Owner	Before: Writes detailed requirements documents, manages backlogs manually	→	After: Intent Strategist: validates AI-generated user stories, drives business alignment
QA Engineer	Before: Manual test creation after development is complete	→	After: Quality Strategist: validates AI-generated test scenarios, proactive quality ownership
DevOps Engineer	Before: Manual pipeline configuration and reactive incident response	→	After: Reliability Architect: validates AI-generated IaC, self-healing systems design

Start Your AI-DLC Journey

Four concrete paths forward:

1

AI-DLC Workflows Repository

Steering files & rules — drop into Kiro or your AI coding tool today

3

Skill Builder Course

Self-paced for your entire team — scale AI-DLC across 10, 100, or 1,000 developers

2

AI-DLC White Paper

Deep methodology dive — your 'convince the CTO' document

4

AI-DLC Workshop ★

Hands-on with YOUR use case — where transformation actually happens

"Nobody loses their job. Everyone levels up. AI handles the toil; humans handle the judgment."